



DO MORE WITH THE AMAZON ECHO

MAKE ALEXA WORK FOR YOU

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So now you have an Amazon Echo, and have been interacting with it. At this point, it is more or less a glorified bluetooth speaker. There are still a number of things that you can do with the device to improve your experience. We start with relatively simple workshops that add a few functionalities, and move on to more advanced tasks such as creating your own custom skills. While we have chosen very particular end goals for each of these workshops, the same approaches and techniques can be used for a wide number of ideas, or tasks to totally customise and improve the user experience that you have with Alexa on an Echo speaker. These workshops work with any Alexa-enabled speaker.

PAIR SUPPORTED STREAMING SERVICES

Alexa treats the music services available as a “skill”, and you have to enable the skill once to use the particular streaming service at any time. On

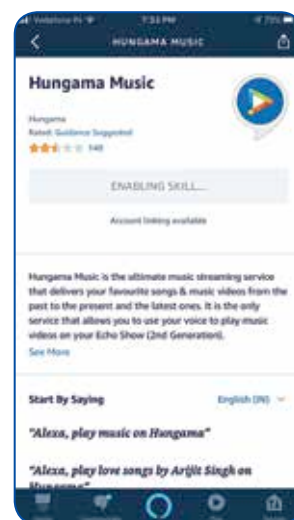
the Alexa app, go to **Settings > Music > Link New Service > JioSaavn > Enable to Use**. You will then need to login in to JioSaavn and Authorize Alexa. Now go to **Settings > Music > Default Services** and change **Default Music Library** to **JioSaavn**. Note that there is no option to change the **Default Station** in the India region to JioSaavn, and no **Artists and Genre Stations** option that is available in the US region. According to Amazon, support for custom playlists on JioSaavn is coming soon, but it is possible to request particular artists, genres or tracks. A bonus feature that seems to be made for local consumption is the ability to request songs featuring a particular actor. The same approach can be used to add Hungama or Gaana as default services on

Alexa. Alexa does support playback of custom playlists on Hungama, but not on Gaana.

PAIR SPOTIFY

Unfortunately, Spotify does not support integration with Amazon Alexa in India yet. It is just simpler to use the Echo as a bluetooth speaker and control the playback from the Spotify app. However, there is a rather painful work around if you really want to do it.

On a web browser, go to **Amazon.in > Settings > Your Account > Content & Devices > Preferences > Country / Region Settings** and change the country from **India** to **US**. You will be required to provide a US street address for doing the same. Note that your Kindle account will be transferred to Amazon.



Linking a streaming service

